

SHENZHEN KSTAR SCIENCE & TECH (002518.SZ)

2Q26 miss on renewables products, strong data center order momentum with sales growth set to accelerate in 2H26E; Buy

On Aug 27, 2026, Kstar announced 2Q26 results that missed GSe due to lower renewable products (ESS and solar inverters) sales (-13% yoy per GSe), while data center products growth (+27% yoy) remained solid. 2Q26 sales/GP/OP/NP were Rmb1,351mn/394mn/174mn/151mn (+11%/+13%/+25%/+5% yoy, and -13%/-16%/-14%/-11% vs. GSe). Implied 2Q26 GPM/OPM/NPM were 29%/13%/11% (Opp/+1pp/-1pp yoy), -1pp/0pp/0pp vs. GSe. **New orders momentum for data center products has gone up significantly since May 2026 across the overseas and domestic markets, and the company notes the production plan for 3Q26E is meaningfully higher vs. 2Q26 supporting sequential shipment growth in 3Q-4Q26E** and they are actively expanding capacity for AIDC high-power UPS given a relatively full utilization rate. Kstar positions itself as **on track with the industry transition towards 800 VDC architecture on a global level** and as one of the domestic leaders in terms of having 800 VDC products in site testing at AI data centers with frontier compute chips. Management expects residential ESS (mainly battery packs sold to SolarEdge) to see mild yoy sales growth in full-year 2026 given intensified competition in Europe, while C&I ESS should see higher sales growth in 2026 which is also margin-accretive. We expect the solar inverter weakness to continue in 2H26E but the impact on firmwide performance to be minimal going forward as total revenue mix shrinks to 6%/4% in 2026E/27E from 17% in 2025. All in, we revise down our 2026-30E net income forecasts by 12% on average, while we continue to expect **strong data center products sales growth into 2H26E (+40% yoy) and 2027E (+29% yoy)**. Accordingly, our 12m-TP moves to Rmb60.0 (vs. Rmb67.0 previously), still based on 26x 2028E P/E discounted back to 2027E with 11% CoE. With the stock trading at **27x/18x P/E against a 35% yoy earnings CAGR in 2026E-28E**, we continue to see an attractive return from Kstar. Maintain Buy. Key takeaways from the earnings call on Aug 28:

Data center product sales saw growth recovering to +17%/+27% in 1H26/2Q26 at Rmb1,557mn/907mn (GSe, accounting for 60%/67% of total sales), in line with our expectations. By region, overseas sales were slightly higher than domestic sales. **New orders momentum has gone up significantly since May 2026** across overseas and domestic markets, and the company notes the production plan for 3Q26E is meaningfully higher vs. 2Q26 supporting sequential shipment growth in 3Q-4Q26E, and they are actively expanding capacity for AIDC high-power UPS given

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a relatively full utilization rate currently. Management believes data center segment sales growth will remain strong in 2026-28 backed by a solid customer/project pipeline.

- In overseas markets, for customers with an electricals background: (1) Kstar received new orders for AIDC high-power UPS from its existing European customer recently, and may start shipment in 4Q26E-1Q27E depending on the readiness of Kstar's Vietnamese factory; and (2) shipments of the first-batch order for the existing Taiwan customer have almost concluded and Kstar is testing its MW-level UPS (vs. supplying 600kW UPS previously). Regarding integrator/co-location customers: (1) The >Rmb200mn UPS order for a European data center will start shipment in September-October 2026; and (2) The company is expanding its presence in SEA markets within local and global colocation companies. Kstar is also in different testing/small-volume phases with several new overseas electricals/integrator/colocation customers based in Taiwan, Japan, Europe, with initial volume orders expected to land in 4Q26E-1Q27E.
- In China, Kstar notes that domestic data center construction activities have meaningfully picked up in 2026YTD vs. 2025, as its domestic colocation customers are seeing robust project pipelines this year (>200% growth vs. 2025) that can support accelerating electrical equipment demand expansion into 2H26E-2028E.

Segment GPM was largely stable at 33.9% (vs. 33.6% in 1H25) as a higher domestic GPM (driven by higher mix from high-power AIDC products) was offset by FX headwinds for overseas margins. All in, we expect further sales growth acceleration in 2H26E (+40% yoy) with sequential growth in 3Q-4Q26E and a solid GPM at 33.9% in 2H26E.

800 VDC product development ongoing: The company positions itself as on track with the industry transition towards 800 VDC architecture on a global level and as one of the domestic leaders in terms of having 800 VDC products in site testing at AI data centers with frontier compute chips. Kstar plans to send its 800 VDC products for onsite testing for 3-6 months in Europe and Southeast Asia in October 2026, and believes initial commercial orders will likely arrive around 2Q27E at the earliest for Kstar as well as other domestic peers, depending on end-customers' (mainly US hyperscalers') feedback. Management is open to different business models including ODM and using its own brand. For solid state transformers (SSTs), Kstar continues to target a launch for SST modules around end-2026 and SST systems in 2027E, noting that it will take at least 2 years from now before seeing industry-wide mass adoption of SST globally.

Limited impact so far from US executive order restricting bulk-part power system electric equipment ([link](#)). As Kstar mainly acts as an ODM for US business, they currently see limited impact after reviewing this policy. The company is committed to further deepening its overseas (incl. US) footprint with customers' support, by expanding capacity in Vietnam, potentially setting up a second factory, and having contingency plans in case of any escalation in geopolitical restrictions.

Renewables segment sales declined -13% to Rmb432mn (GSe, accounting for 32% of total sales) and was the key reason for the 2Q26 sales miss.

- Energy storage sales of Rmb309mn (GSe) in 2Q26 moderated to +67% yoy/-31% qoq, likely driven by slower residential ESS growth. On sales mix, residential was slightly higher than commercial & industrial (C&I) ESS in 1H26. Management expects

residential ESS (mainly battery packs sold to SolarEdge) to see mild yoy sales growth in full-year 2026 given intensified competition in the European residential ESS market on relatively high industry penetration, while C&I ESS should see an approximate doubling of sales growth in 2026 which is also margin-accretive. We model +3% ESS sales yoy growth in 2H26 led by C&I applications.

- Solar inverter sales (~80% from China, ~20% from overseas) remained subdued at Rmb187mn/90mn (GSe) in 1H26/2Q26, -59%/-68% as domestic new solar installation was -66% yoy in 1H26. We expect this trend to continue and model -62% yoy sales decline in 2H26E. That said, the solar inverter weakness will have minimal impact on firmwide performance as total revenue mix shrinks to 6%/4% in 2026E/27E from 17% in 2025, in our view.
- On margins, overall renewables product segment GPM improved by +1.4pp yoy/+3.7pp hoh to 22.2% in 1H26 driven by higher overseas mix and better product mix, and we forecast 23.1% total segment GPM in 2H26E.

On **costs and expenses**, Kstar has issued a pricing increase notice to customers and plans to raise ASP for both data center and renewables products by 8%~15% starting from September 2026 in light of raw material price inflation pressure. Meanwhile, the company will continue to optimize supply chain and inventory management especially in power electronics. FX losses amounted to -Rmb44mn (vs. FX gains of +Rmb20mn in 1H25). Share-based compensation expenses were Rmb18mn in 1H26 and a similar level of SBC expense is expected in 2H26E.

Exhibit 1: Kstar 2Q26 financial summary

Kstar (002518.SZ)	1Q25	2Q25	3Q25	4Q25	1Q26	2Q26	yoy %	qoq %	Prior 2Q26 Gse	Diff
Revenue (Rmb mn)	943	1,219	1,446	1,662	1,240	1,351	11%	9%	1,561	-13%
Gross profit (Rmb mn)	277	350	404	497	369	394	13%	7%	468	-16%
EBIT (Rmb mn)	103	140	208	172	163	174	25%	7%	203	-14%
Net profit (Rmb mn)	111	144	190	165	139	151	5%	9%	170	-11%
EPS (Rmb)	0.19	0.25	0.33	0.28	0.24	0.26	5%	9%	0.29	-11%
Gross margin (Rmb mn)	29%	29%	28%	30%	30%	29%	0pp	-1pp	30%	-1pp
EBIT margin (Rmb mn)	11%	11%	14%	10%	13%	13%	1pp	0pp	13%	0pp
Net margin (Rmb mn)	12%	12%	13%	10%	11%	11%	-1pp	0pp	11%	0pp

Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Earnings revisions and TP: We revise down our 2026-30E net income forecasts by 12% on average mainly to reflect the results, domestic solar business weakness, softening momentum for the residential ESS business, and FX headwinds impacting overseas GPM and FX losses, while we continue to expect strong data center products sales growth into 2H26E and 2027E. Accordingly, our 12m-TP moves to Rmb60.0 (vs. Rmb67.0 previously), still based on 26x 2028E P/E discounted back to 2027E. With the stock trading at **27x/18x P/E against 35% yoy earnings CAGR in 2026E-28E**, we continue to see an attractive return from Kstar. Maintain Buy.

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12m Price Target: Rmb60

Price: Rmb35.47

Upside: 69.2%

Buy

GS Forecast

		12/25	12/26E	12/27E	12/28E
Market cap: Rmb20.7bn / \$3.1bn	Revenue (Rmb mn) New	5,270.3	6,213.6	7,946.2	9,787.6
Enterprise value: Rmb20.0bn / \$3.0bn	Revenue (Rmb mn) Old	5,270.3	7,137.4	9,144.3	11,336.1
3m ADTV :Rmb606.1mn/ \$89.6mn	EBITDA (Rmb mn)	731.2	988.4	1,374.8	1,788.3
China	EPS (Rmb) New	1.05	1.33	1.95	2.56
China Industrial Tech & Machinery	EPS (Rmb) Old	0.99	1.55	2.22	2.86
	P/E (X)	29.5	26.7	18.2	13.9
M&A Rank: 3	P/B (X)	3.7	3.9	3.4	2.9
Leases incl. in net debt & EV?: No	Dividend yield (%)	1.5	1.7	2.7	3.6
	CROCI (%)	18.2	21.1	23.3	27.1
		3/26	6/26	9/26E	12/26E
	EPS (Rmb)	0.24	0.26	0.41	0.42

Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Research estimates, FactSet. Price as of 28 Aug 2026 close.

Investment thesis, valuation methodology, and risks

Investment thesis: Kstar specializes in electric power conversion technology, providing data centers and energy storage systems (ESS) with a constant and stable power supply. It has achieved the largest UPS (uninterruptible power supply) shipments in China for more than 20 years (per CCID). For Kstar, we expect the company to deliver solid revenue/net income growth, mainly driven by: (1) overseas AIDC customer expansion and product innovation (including high-power UPS, 800 VDC, SST etc.) serving a broader regions including the North American market; (2) domestic data center revenue growth pick-up, riding on increased capex from both SOE and POE hyperscalers and expanding customer base in the domestic data center market, and (3) overseas ESS business recovery benefiting from channel inventories normalization and C&I ESS demand. We are Buy rated on the stock considering the attractive P/E valuation on its long-term growth profile and better margin and returns vs. peers.

Price target risks & methodology: Our 12m target price of Rmb60.0 is based on 2028E P/E of 26x discounted back to 2027E at 11% CoE. Key downside risks: (1) Lower-than-expected US ODM order growth; (2) Slower new product launches especially 800V DC products; (3) Lower-than-expected overseas ESS growth and margin.

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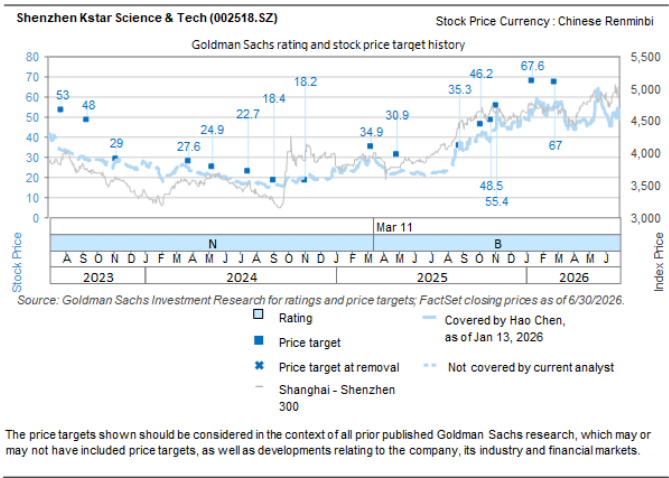
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Price target and rating history chart(s)



Target price history table(s)
Shenzhen Kstar Science & Tech (002518.SZ)

Date of report	Target price (Rmb)	Closing price (Rmb)
25-Feb-26	67.00	54.61
13-Jan-26	67.60	51.09
06-Nov-25	55.40	48.73
26-Oct-25	48.50	39.10
07-Oct-25	46.20	41.29
28-Aug-25	35.30	37.90
28-Apr-25	30.90	21.98
11-Mar-25	34.90	28.38
04-Nov-24	18.20	19.39
05-Sep-24	18.40	16.45
18-Jul-24	22.70	17.30
09-May-24	24.90	22.46
27-Mar-24	27.60	23.24
07-Nov-23	29.00	28.56
13-Sep-23	48.00	28.69

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